

HISTORY HACK · DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION

Document-Based Question

US.43 — Describe the impact of the Great Depression on the American people, including mass unemployment, migration, and Hoovervilles.

US.46 — Analyze the effects of and the controversies arising from New Deal economic policies, including charges of socialism and President Franklin D. Roosevelt’s “court packing” attempt.

TEACHER EDITION — scoring guide and expected evidence. Not for student distribution.

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Directions. Analyze the three primary sources below. Then respond to the prompt using evidence from ALL THREE documents and your own historical knowledge.

The sources

Document A

Huey Long, "Share Our Wealth" Radio Address, February 23, 1934 (Congressional Record, public domain)

“How many men ever went to a barbecue and would let one man take off the table what was intended for nine-tenths of the people to eat? The same is true of the old U.S.A. Any man with a thimble full of sense ought to know that if you make 3 persons work to give 1 person what the 3 have earned, that the 1 person is getting 75 percent of all that is produced and that the other 3 are only getting 25 percent of what they produce...We must limit the size of the big man's fortune.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT A

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or
hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make
the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how
does that shape it?

Document B

American Liberty League Statement of Principles, 1934 (Library of Congress, public domain)

“The organization of a non-partisan body...to defend and uphold the Constitution...to teach the necessity of respect for the rights of persons and property as fundamental to every form of government...The League was formed to combat what its founders believed to be an unconstitutional extension of federal power that threatened the American system of free enterprise and individual liberty.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT B

H — Historical context

What was happening when this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how does that shape it?

Document C

United States Supreme Court, *Schechter Poultry Corp. v. United States*, 295 U.S. 495 (1935) (public domain)

“Congress cannot delegate legislative powers to the President to such an extent as to confer unlimited authority...The attempted delegation of that authority here is clearly excessive...Extraordinary conditions do not create or enlarge constitutional power. The Constitution established a national government with powers deemed to be adequate for the governmental purposes of the founders. We look to the Constitution itself, and to its history, for the solution of constitutional questions.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT C

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or
hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make
the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how
does that shape it?

The question

PROMPT: Using all three documents and your knowledge of New Deal opposition (1933–1941), construct an argument that answers: How did critics of the New Deal from BOTH the left and the right, as well as the judiciary, reflect deeper disagreements about the proper limits of federal power

1. and what did these critiques ultimately reveal about the New Deal's lasting tensions? In your response, you MUST: 1. Analyze each document using the HIPP framework

2. at least ONE HIPP element per document. 2. Identify whether each document represents left-wing, right-wing, or judicial criticism, and explain the core argument each critic made against the New Deal. 3. Construct a central argument using all three documents AND at least two pieces of outside historical knowledge that explains how the simultaneous left and right opposition to the New Deal reveals the ideological boundaries within which FDR was operating. 4. Evaluate: Did the critics ultimately weaken, redirect, or strengthen the New Deal

3. and which critique proved most consequential for FDR's second term?

Plan your answer

Your claim	
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Source	Evidence you will use	Why it supports your claim
Document A		
Document B		
Document C		
Outside knowledge		

Write your response

Scoring guide

Pts	6-point scale
6	Exemplary. All three documents analyzed with accurate HIPP elements. Correctly identifies Long as left-wing, Liberty League as right-wing, and Schechter as judicial criticism. Constructs a coherent central argument about the ideological middle ground FDR occupied. Uses all three documents plus at least two outside facts. Evaluates which critique was most consequential with specific, accurate reasoning (Court-packing plan, Second New Deal pivot). Writing is rigorous and well-organized.
5	Advanced. Three documents analyzed with HIPP (one element may be imprecise). Central argument addresses the ideological spectrum with all three documents. At least one outside fact. Evaluation of consequences present with some depth.
4	Proficient. Two or three documents referenced with some HIPP analysis. Argument addresses left/right/judicial spectrum. At least one outside fact. Evaluation present but underdeveloped.
3	Adequate. At least two documents referenced. Argument identifies some dimensions of New Deal opposition. Limited HIPP analysis. Some outside knowledge.
2	Developing. One or two documents referenced with minimal analysis. Argument is vague. Little outside knowledge.
1	Beginning. One document summarized without analysis. No argument. No HIPP.
0	No response or completely off-topic.

Expected evidence and document analysis. DOCUMENT ANALYSIS EXPECTATIONS: - Doc A (Long): Left-wing populist criticism; context = 1934 radio address; POV = insufficient redistribution - Doc B (Liberty League): Right-wing/conservative criticism; POV = unconstitutional federal expansion - Doc C (Schechter): Judicial/constitutional criticism; context = 1935 NIRA invalidation; POV = originalist limits on delegation KEY EVIDENCE EXPECTED: Huey Long's Share Our Wealth clubs (4.5 million members by 1935); Long's assassination (September 1935); Father Coughlin; American Liberty League founding members (Al Smith, Pierre du Pont); Schechter Poultry v. United States (1935, struck down NIRA); Butler v. United States (1936, struck down AAA); Second New Deal (1935) as response to left critics; Revenue Act of 1935 ('Soak the Rich'); Court-packing plan (1937); 'switch in time that saved nine'; Four Horsemen conservative justices.

Sourcing. Every document above carries its own citation as written in the item record. Verify each against the holding institution before classroom use — an unsourced primary source is worse than a missing one.

